
Urgent Call for Accountability: Protecting Callaway County Taxpayers and Land from Data Center Development

From Englassed musetech <yvette.musetech@gmail.com>

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To Jim.Schulte@house.mo.gov <Jim.Schulte@house.mo.gov>; Gary Jungermann <GJungermann@Callawaycounty.org>; Christopher Scott <cscott@callawaycounty.org>; Curt Warfield <cwarfield@callawaycounty.org>

Dear Commissioner Jungermann and all the people addressed in this message,

As a resident and taxpayer of Callaway County, I am writing to you directly to express my deep concerns and formal opposition to the proposed data center project in our county, unless stringent, legally binding protections for our community are established first.

While economic growth is important, it should never come at the expense of the people who live here, pay taxes here, and tend to this land. AI data centers are not standard commercial developments; they are massive industrial operations disguised as tech offices. I urge you to look beyond the promised tax revenues and weigh the permanent, irreversible impacts this facility will have on our county.

I ask that you carefully consider the following critical impacts before moving forward:

Erosion of Our Rural Heritage and Beautiful Land: Callaway County is defined by its agricultural strength, open spaces, and natural beauty. Dropping a massive, industrial data center complex into our landscape fundamentally disrupts the rural character of our area, harms local wildlife corridors, and fragments productive agricultural land. Once this beautiful land is cleared and industrialized, we can never get it back.

The Burden on Local Taxpayers: We need concrete guarantees that local residents will not foot the bill for the immense infrastructure upgrades these facilities require. The massive energy and water demands of data centers frequently lead to rising utility rates for local citizens and put an unprecedented strain on our electric grid. Taxpayers should not see their hard-earned money used to subsidize corporate utilities while risking blackouts or rate hikes.

Severe Environmental and Resource Strain: The cooling systems required for these centers consume millions of gallons of water daily, threatening our local water tables. Furthermore, the constant, low-frequency hum of industrial chillers and massive backup generators creates a permanent radius of noise pollution that shatters the peace of rural residential life.

As our Presiding Commissioner, your first duty is to safeguard the well-being of Callaway County's citizens and land. At a bare minimum, I urge the Commission to institute an immediate moratorium on approvals to conduct an independent, comprehensive impact study. We must mandate strict property-line noise mitigation, prohibit building in sensitive environmental areas or floodplains, and require thermal pollution studies to ensure these facilities do not create localized "heat domes" that damage surrounding crops.

The taxpayers of Callaway County are watching this decision closely. We expect our elected leaders to protect our resources, our pocketbooks, and our way of life.

Thank you for your time, your leadership, and your attention to this critical matter. I look forward to your response.

Sincerely,

Yvette English

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